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# 5-MINUTE HOMEMADE LATTE (NO FANCY EQUIPMENT!)



 **5 MINS**  **1 LATTE**      **5** (13 ratings)

Make a homemade latte without any special equipment! That's right, no espresso machine or milk frother is needed for this latte at home. This DIY version saves you time and money and is completely customizable with your favorite [latte syrup](#).

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posted by **BECCA MILLS** on **JUNE 2, 2022** (last updated Jun 25, 2025)

*This post may contain affiliate links.*

**I** absolutely love cooling down with an iced latte on hot summer days, but there's just nothing like a piping hot, foamy latte when cozy mornings are waiting. And I'll show you my step-by-step method for how to make the perfect latte at home without any fancy equipment needed!



Making lattes at home solves the eternal Saturday morning dilemma — “do I get out of bed and go to my local coffee shop to get a creamy, luxurious latte, or do I stay in bed?” You can have your cake, errr...latte, and drink it too!

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## A MACHINE

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A latte is an espresso drink, so its base is, well, espresso! Now, if you don't have an espresso machine at home, there are a few methods I use for making espresso drinks without one. Espresso machines are crucial for pressurizing water and forcing it through very finely ground coffee that's tightly packed, resulting in a rich, bold flavor with crema, or the caramel-colored, creamy foam on top.

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Without pressurization, it's challenging to achieve the crema, but these substitutes are pretty darn good!

**Strongly Brewed Coffee:** You will need *less* water in your coffee-to-water ratio when brewing coffee. The general recommendation is a 15:1 ratio of water to coffee for a strong brew. Ultimately, it depends on your preferences.

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While you can brew the coffee any method you prefer, a french press is a great option for strong coffee.

**Stovetop Espresso:** make espresso on the stovetop using a **Moka pot**, which is a classic Italian method for brewing strong coffee.

**Use Instant Espresso** or strongly brew instant coffee.

**Aeropress:** makes strong, concentrated coffee.

**Nespresso:** ok, this is a machine but it's not an official espresso machine (IMO) but rather an easy, at-home option for making espresso without the pricey, fancy machine. So if you have one, of course, use it!



## MY SECRET METHOD TO FROTH MILK

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In addition to espresso, a latte is about two-thirds steamed milk, and topped with the foam from said frothed milk. Whole milk is the creamiest milk that will froth the best, and for a dairy-free option, oat milk is my go-to.

My favorite way to froth milk at home for a homemade latte is to heat milk in a **mason jar**, then top it and shake it vigorously (while dancing...because happiness makes better lattes) until it's doubled in size and foamy.

Please keep these tips in mind when you use the mason jar method for frothing milk:

**Do not microwave the lid.** It's metal and cannot go in the microwave.

Carefully remove the jar from the microwave, and **use a towel or potholders** to prevent burning your hands, as needed.

**Carefully remove the lid from the jar**, removing it slowly in case any pressure has accumulated. I like to use a towel to remove it, just in case there is any splatter or excess heat.

**Grab your milk of choice and fill the jar halfway.**

**Shake away until foamy!**

If you don't have a lid for your jar, heat the milk then use a small whisk to froth the milk, vigorously whisking until foamy. Of course, a **hand-held milk frother** is an inexpensive piece of equipment that works quite well, too.

## **BARISTA TIPS FOR POURING**

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Now that you've made very strong coffee, heated the milk, and shaken it up to make it foamy, all that's left to do is pour the latte. During my time as a barista working at Caribou Coffee, I learned to tap and swirl the milk before pouring to create a fine foam.



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swirls with the espresso to fully combine, and then top it off with the remaining foam.

**Tap, swirl, and pour the milk in like a pro!**

**Just look at that foamy top!**

**Consider this:** if you are using strongly brewed coffee instead of espresso, use less milk for a more authentic latte flavor.

## HOMEMADE LATTE FLAVORS

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Sometimes it's good to mix it up. There are so many flavors to add to a latte whether it's pumpkin spice lattes in the fall, peppermint mochas in the winter, or a classic favorite.

**Vanilla Latte** with **vanilla bean syrup**

**Autumn Spice** for a fun fall-inspired taste

**Mocha** with **chocolate syrup**

**Floral lavender latte**

**Caramel Latte** with **my favorite caramel syrup**

**Peppermint Mocha**

**Brown Sugar Syrup**

For a basic sweetener, just add a little **simple syrup**

*Did you make this recipe?* Please **leave a star rating and review** in the form below. I appreciate your feedback, and it helps others, too!

# HOW TO MAKE A HOMEMADE LATTE (NO FANCY EQUIPMENT)

🕒 **PREP: 5 MINS** ⌚ **TOTAL: 5 MINS** 🍴 **SERVINGS: 1 LATTE**

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*Make a homemade latte without any special equipment! That's right, no espresso machine or milk frother is needed for this latte at home. This DIY version saves you time and money and is completely customizable with your favorite **latte syrup**.*

|      |    |    |    |
|------|----|----|----|
| 1/2x | 1x | 2x | 3x |
|------|----|----|----|

## INGREDIENTS

- ☐ **3 ounces** espresso (2 shots), or ½ cup strong coffee
- ☐ **6-8 ounces** whole milk, or milk of choice
- ☐ **Latte Syrup**, optional

## EQUIPMENT

- ☐ **16-Ounce Wide Mouth Mason Jar**
- ☐ **Handheld Frother Wand** optional
- ☐ **Double-Wall Glass Coffee Mugs**

## INSTRUCTIONS

continue heating in 30-second increments up to another minute. You want the milk hot, but not boiling.

*3 ounces espresso (2 shots), 6-8 ounces whole milk*

- 2 Carefully remove the jar of milk from the microwave; you may need to use a towel or potholder as it will be hot. Put the lid on the mason jar, making sure it is tightly sealed, and shake vigorously for 30 seconds to 1 minute. *See notes below for additional frothing methods.*
- 3 Continue using a towel or potholder and remove the lid carefully, being aware of any pressure that may have built up in the jar. Pour the milk over the espresso, topping with any foam that remains in the jar. Serve immediately.

## NOTES

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Use caution when shaking and opening the mason jar! Make sure the lid is on tight, use a towel or pot-holder to hold the jar as needed, and open the lid carefully (I again, use a towel in hand).

### **Additional frothing methods:**

Use a milk frother wand

Shake the jar of milk *before* microwaving. Make sure the milk doubles in size before microwaving, then once heated, immediately pour it into your espresso.

Heat milk in a saucepan on the stovetop (or again in the microwave) then use a whisk to froth the milk.

**Strong Coffee:** if using strongly brewed coffee instead of espresso, consider using more coffee/less milk for a more latte-like coffee-forward flavor.



Watch on

**NUTRITION INFORMATION:** *Calories: 107kcal, Carbohydrates: 9g, Protein: 6g, Fat: 6g, Saturated Fat: 3g, Polyunsaturated Fat: 0.2g, Monounsaturated Fat: 1g, Cholesterol: 20mg, Sodium: 73mg, Potassium: 320mg, Sugar: 8g, Vitamin A: 276IU, Vitamin C: 0.1mg, Calcium: 210mg, Iron: 0.1mg*

 **COURSE: BEVERAGE**  **AUTHOR: BECCA MILLS**  **CUISINE: AMERICAN**

*Did you make this recipe?*

Please **leave a star rating and review** in the form below. I appreciate your feedback, and it helps others, too!

*The post "4 Ways to Make a Homemade Lattes" was originally published in March 2017; in May 2022 each latte was re-published as individual posts.*



## MORE SUGGESTIONS

COFFEE & TEA

*posted by* **BECCA MILLS** *on* **JUNE 2, 2022** *(last updated Jun 25, 2025)*

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## 12 COMMENTS ON "5-MINUTE HOMEMADE LATTE (NO FANCY EQUIPMENT!)"

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**KELLEY** – JUNE 4, 2022 @ 6:58 AM [REPLY](#)



This is so informative! I will be trying it soon. Thank you! Love it!

**BECCA MILLS** – JUNE 4, 2022 @ 12:29 PM [REPLY](#)

I'm so glad to hear you found it helpful! Thanks, Kelley!

**SARAH COWARD** – OCTOBER 13, 2024 @ 8:54 AM [REPLY](#)



Thanks for the info, never made a latte before, just love drinking them. Waiting for a milk frothing machine to arrive before I try out your recipe.

**BECCA MILLS** – OCTOBER 13, 2024 @ 10:22 AM [REPLY](#)

Looking forward to hearing how it turns out!





I wondered what a latte was. Your title saying no special equipment enticed me to check out your recipe. Great explanation and enough details that I can make one. I now know that I drink something very similar to a latte every day at home. My hubby likes strong coffee, and I add sugar and an all natural coffee creamer until the color is tan. I may try frothing it and some milk together now that I've read this.

**BECCA MILLS** – MARCH 4, 2025 @ 10:12 AM [REPLY](#)

Awesome, thanks for sharing, I'm glad you found it helpful!

**KLAUDIA** – APRIL 1, 2025 @ 10:07 AM [REPLY](#)



This was really good, the perfect combination of coffee and milk and I had it over ice! The perfect drink ❤️

**BECCA MILLS** – APRIL 1, 2025 @ 11:59 AM [REPLY](#)

Fabulous, so glad to hear you enjoyed it! Thanks for your review, Klaudia!

**KATHRYN** – OCTOBER 26, 2025 @ 9:36 AM [REPLY](#)



This worked great! Instead of using microwave I heated up in sauce pan with my whisk. Used funnel to put into mason jar to shake/pour. I substituted almond milk for dairy free and topped with cinnamon sprinkles for a fall rich flavor! Yum. I didn't think I could do this at home before finding your recipe.

Yay! So happy to hear, thanks, Kathryn!

**DEBBIE** – JANUARY 1, 2026 @ 6:57 AM [REPLY](#)



This recipe is perfect to make a latte at home, the secret is good espresso! My husband loved it and making it required little effort.

**BECCA MILLS** – JANUARY 2, 2026 @ 10:03 AM [REPLY](#)

Love to hear it! Thanks, Debbie!

★★★★★ 5 from 13 votes ([7 ratings without comment](#))

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